

Point-in-Time Multi-Agent LLM Trading: A Reproducible LangGraph Stack with Regime-Conditioned Evaluation and Fair Backtesting

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Abstract

Large language models are increasingly used in financial decision pipelines, yet published agent stacks are often hard to reproduce and rarely evaluated under distinct market conditions on historical as-of dates. We present **Hindsight 20/20**, an open **LangGraph** stack for single-asset trading with structured **Pydantic** outputs, a **simulation end date** for point-in-time data, optional **ticker anonymization**, and a fee-aware **paper backtest**. We evaluate the **full** pipeline on **RELIANCE.NS** in two **exogenous** windows—a **bear regime** (underlying return -17.4% , Aug 2024–Jan 2025) and a **bull regime** ($+19.3\%$, Jan–May 2025)—each from \$100,000 paper cash. The agent loses less than buy-and-hold in the bear window (-7.5% vs -17.4%) but captures less of the rally in the bull window ($+8.7\%$ vs $+19.3\%$). Frozen CSV artifacts and scripts reproduce tables and figures.

Keywords: algorithmic trading; large language models; multi-agent systems; reproducibility; point-in-time data; market regimes.

0.1 Introduction

Researchers are experimenting with large language models (LLMs) inside trading workflows. Building research-grade stacks remains difficult: temporal constraints are often implicit, and evaluations rarely ask how the **same** implementation behaves when the **underlying trend** differs.

We present **Hindsight 20/20**, an open **LangGraph** implementation focused on reproducibility and auditable evaluation. **Structured outputs**, optional **anonymization**, and a **simulation end date** bound data access. A **paper backtest** replays signals with configurable fees.

We evaluate the **full** pipeline (`PAPER_ABLATION=full`) on **RELIANCE.NS** in two **independent** backtests over calendar windows labeled **bear** and **bull** from exogenous underlying returns (Section 4.1). Section 2 surveys related work; Section 3 the system; Section 4 results; Section 5 concludes; Section 6 lists contributions.

0.2 Related Work

LLM agents for trading. Multi-agent frameworks orchestrate specialist roles (Xiao et al., 2024; Yu et al., 2023; Yang et al., 2023). We emphasize **reproducible systems engineering**: one codepath, schema-constrained outputs, temporal controls, and scriptable backtests tied to CSV artifacts.

Point-in-time data and leakage. We treat a simulation end date, vendor routing, and optional anonymization as first-class requirements.

Robustness across market conditions. We contribute a **regime-split** evaluation on one ticker—exogenous bear/bull labels, not regime prediction.

Execution realism. A paper ledger with stated fees links decisions to P&L without microstructure simulation.

0.3 Method / System

Architecture. TradingAgentsGraph wires analysts, **Bull/Bear Researcher** debate roles (internal agents—not market-regime labels), trader, and risk stages. **run_backtest_mvp** uses the same graph as interactive runs.

Structured outputs, PIT policy, anonymization. Pydantic schemas with fallbacks; simulation-date clamps; optional TickerMapper. Frozen E1 runs used anonymization.

Pipeline configuration. Section 4 uses **PAPER_ABLATION=full** (default): all analysts, investment debate, risk phase. Other presets exist for internal use only.

Backtest. `scripts/backtest_mvp.py --dates-csv` writes schedule CSVs with signals, equity, and outlook columns.

0.4 Experiments

0.4.1 Goals and regime definition

Market regimes are assigned **exogenously** from underlying **RELIANCE.NS** buy-and-hold return over each window: **bear** if return $\leq -10\%$; **bull** if $\geq +10\%$. Each run starts from **\$100,000** fresh cash.

0.4.2 Protocol

Regime	Processed window	Artifact CSV
Bear	2024-08-01 .. 2025-01-03	results/dates-REL-aug-2024-jan-2025-b
Bull	2025-01-01 .. 2025-05-16	results/dates-REL-jan-2025-june-2025-

Shared: **PAPER_ABLATION=full**; **zerodha_delivery**; **slippage_bps=0**; LLM **qwen/qwen3.5-flash-02-23**

Bull schedule targets June 2025 but the frozen artifact ends **2025-05-16** (API limits).

0.4.3 Results

Table 1. Agent vs buy-and-hold (\$100,000 start).

Regime	Days	B&H	Agent	End equity	Max	Sharpe	B/H/S	Fees (\$)
					DD		signals	
Bear	111	−17.43%	7.54%	92,459.38	5.11%	−3.12	7/28/76	1,010.32
Bull	94	+19.25%	8.68%	108,675.02	0.47%	+2.62	6/20/68	613.69

In the bear window the agent **outperforms buy-and-hold** with a defensive SELL-heavy profile; in the bull window it **underperforms** despite positive return—partial rally participation only.

Table 2. Selected outlook / stance shares (% of days).

Regime	Field	bullish	bearish	mixed	buy	sell	hold
Bear	market_outlook	10.8	31.5	48.6	—	—	—
Bear	bull_implied_stance	—	—	—	100.0	—	—
Bear	bear_implied_stance	—	—	—	—	88.3	10.8
Bull	market_outlook	21.3	21.3	46.8	—	—	—
Bull	bull_implied_stance	—	—	—	97.9	—	1.1
Bull	bear_implied_stance	—	—	—	—	85.1	12.8

0.4.4 Figures

0.5 Conclusion

We presented an open LangGraph trading stack and **regime-conditioned** evaluation on **RELIANCE.NS**. The full pipeline shows asymmetric behavior: relative protection in the bear window and partial participation in the bull window.

LLM: qwen/qwen3.5-flash-02-23

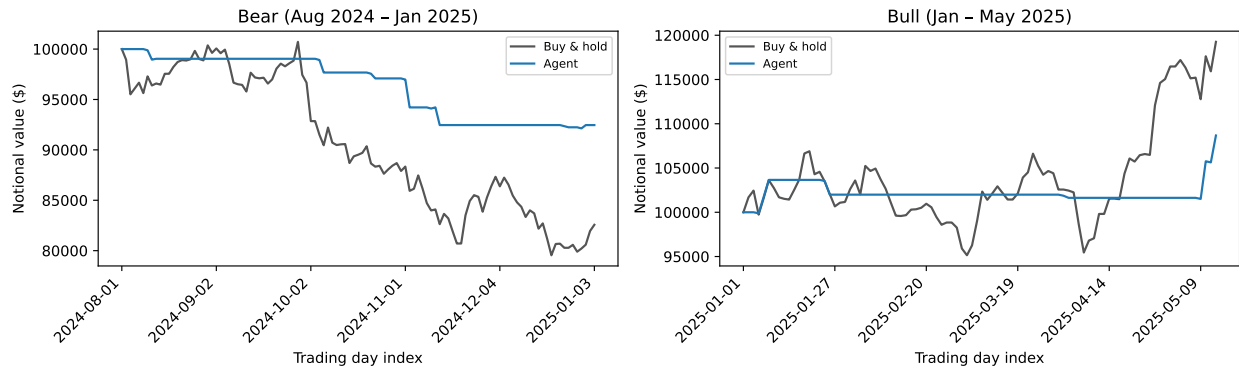


Figure 1: Figure 1. Agent vs buy-and-hold equity by regime.

LLM: qwen/qwen3.5-flash-02-23

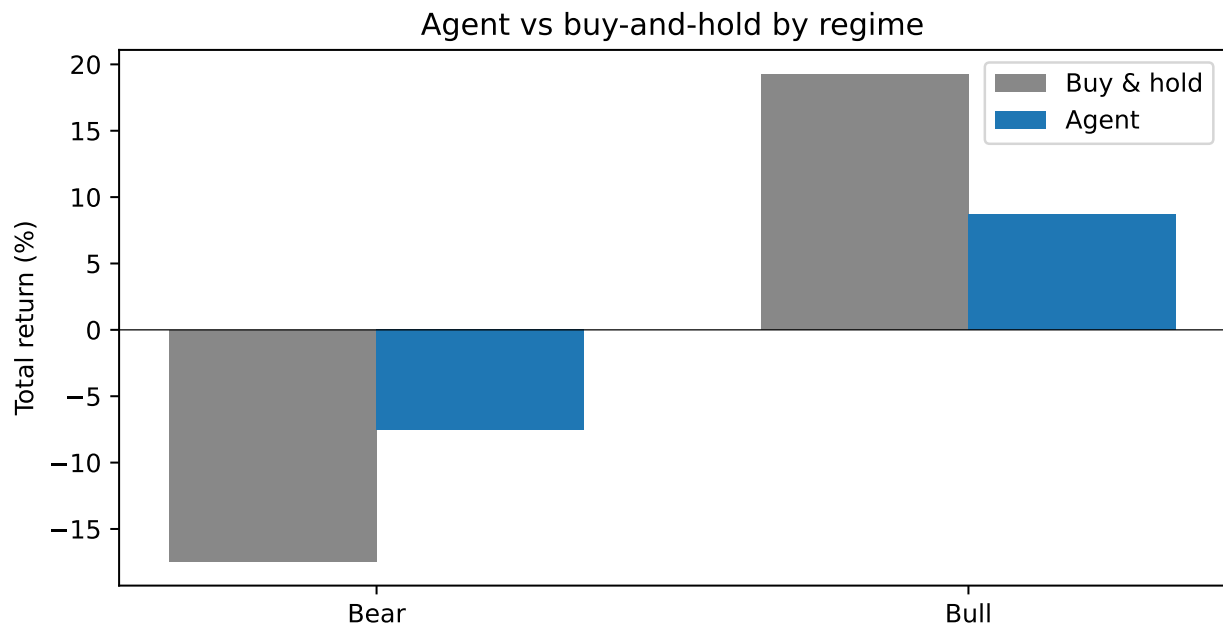


Figure 2: Figure 2. Total return by regime.

LLM: qwen/qwen3.5-flash-02-23

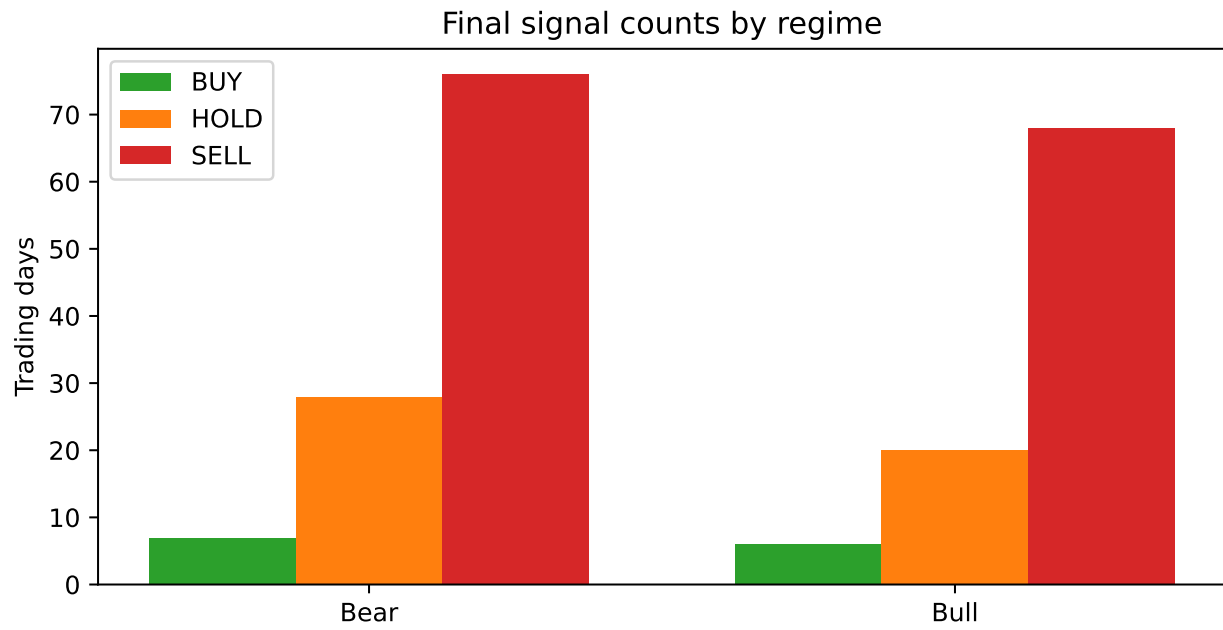


Figure 3: Figure 3. Final signal counts by regime.

LLM: qwen/qwen3.5-flash-02-23

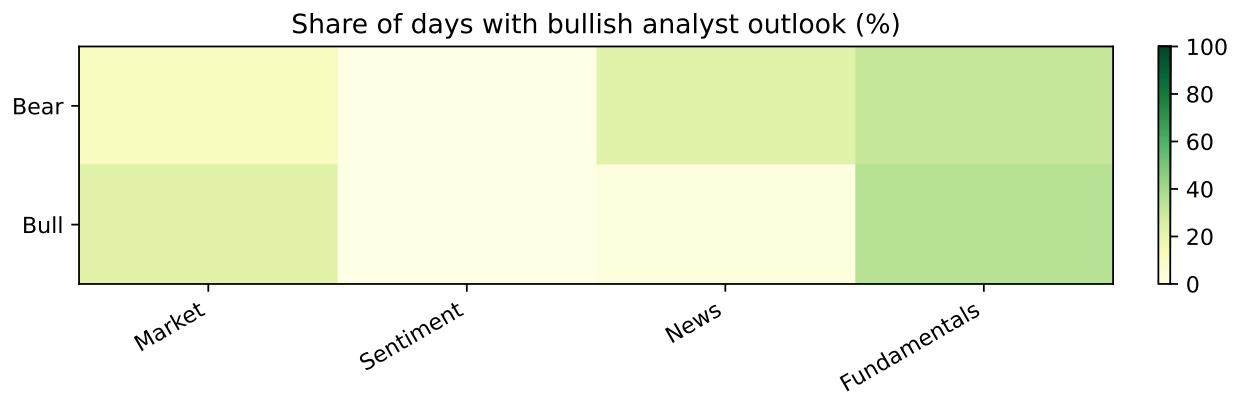


Figure 4: Figure 4. Share of days with bullish analyst outlook.

Limitations. One ticker; bull run truncated at 2025-05-16; single LLM; regimes are exogenous, not predicted by the agent.

0.6 Contributions

1. **Multi-agent decision graph** (S1).
2. **Regime-conditioned evaluation** with frozen bear/bull CSVs (S2).
3. **Structured stage outputs** (S3).
4. **Point-in-time policy and anonymization** (S4).
5. **Backtest harness and analysis artifacts** (S5).

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Not applicable.

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